

DIGI-FIN LITERACY AFRICA

Money Scripts Self-Assessment Workbook

Uncover the unconscious beliefs silently running your financial life — and rewrite them for good.

FREE DOWNLOAD | 5 pages

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Why Do You Keep Making the Same Money Mistakes?

The answer often isn't your income, your intelligence, or your discipline. It's your money scripts — the unconscious beliefs about money formed in childhood that now run on autopilot. Beliefs like 'rich people are greedy,' 'I don't deserve wealth,' or 'digital money is unsafe' were absorbed from parents, culture, religion, and lived experience — usually before age ten. In the digital age, these scripts now show up in entirely new ways.

Script	Core Belief	Digital Risk
1. Money Avoidance	'Digital platforms are for other people, not me'	Missing out on digital savings, credit, and investment
2. Money Worship	'The right online opportunity will make me rich fast'	Falling for Ponzi schemes, crypto scams, high-risk s
3. Money Status	'My online image matters more than my net worth'	Lifestyle inflation, mobile loan debt to maintain socia
4. Money Vigilance	'All digital money is unsafe — I'll stick to cash'	Excluded from digital economy benefits, missing infl

How to Use This Workbook

Read each script, then complete the self-assessment questions. Be radically honest — no one else will read this. The goal is awareness, not judgment.

Script 1 — Digital Money Avoidance

The Core Belief

'Online money is risky. I'm not tech-savvy enough. Digital platforms are for other people.'

How It Shows Up Digitally

Avoiding banking apps even when more convenient. Refusing to use M-Shwari, Mali, or digital investment apps. Missing government financial inclusion programmes (e.g. Hustler Fund, digital SACCOs). Distrusting licensed platforms.

Where It Comes From

Often develops from witnessing digital fraud, hearing stories of people losing money, or growing up without technology access. Can also stem from a deeper belief that financial success is not meant for 'people like me.'

The Cost of This Script

In a world where financial services are increasingly digital-first, avoidance means exclusion. Digital platforms often offer lower fees, higher savings interest, faster transactions, and credit access that traditional banks do not provide.

Rewriting Script 1

Old belief: "Online money is risky. I'm not tech-savvy enough. Digital platforms are for other people." New belief: "Digital financial tools, when used correctly, give me more control — not less." First step: Identify one digital financial tool that would make your life easier. Spend 30 minutes this week learning how it works from an official source (Safaricom, CBK website, or official app tutorial).

Script 2 — Digital Money Worship

The Core Belief

'If I find the right crypto coin / online gig / investment opportunity, I will finally be rich fast.'

How It Shows Up Digitally

Chasing high-risk investments with promises of extraordinary returns. Sports betting as a primary income strategy. Jumping from side hustle to side hustle without building sustainable income. Falling for Ponzi schemes and crypto pump-and-dump scams.

Where It Comes From

Fuelled by social media, where people flaunt success and downplay failure. 'Overnight millionaire' narratives dominate financial content. The desire for financial security is legitimate; the belief that a shortcut exists is the problem.

The Cost of This Script

Money Worshipers often lose significant sums chasing shortcuts — and fail to develop the genuine skills and sustainable habits that create lasting wealth.

Rewriting Script 2

Old belief: "If I find the right crypto coin / online gig / investment opportunity, I will finally be rich fast." New belief: "Consistent habits and disciplined investment build real wealth over time. Shortcuts usually lead backward." First step: Calculate how much you have spent in the last 12 months on high-risk or speculative opportunities. Compare that to what you could have saved or invested conservatively in the same period.

Script 3 — Digital Money Status

The Core Belief

'I must look successful online, no matter what it costs. What people see matters more than what's in my account.'

How It Shows Up Digitally

Buying trending gadgets or experiences primarily to post about them. Lifestyle inflation — spending more as you earn more, never getting ahead. Financial anxiety driven by social comparison. Paying for subscriptions and services to keep up appearances.

Where It Comes From

Digital platforms have made social comparison unavoidable. Instagram, TikTok, and Twitter are highlight reels. Scrolling through them wires the brain to constantly compare your ordinary life with everyone else's curated extraordinary.

The Cost of This Script

Wanjiru (24) earned a respectable salary but was perpetually in debt. Financial counselling revealed she was spending 40% of her income on items associated with the lifestyle of people she followed on Instagram — KSh 0 in savings and KSh 80,000 in mobile loan debt. After unfollowing envy-triggering accounts and setting a social spending budget, she cleared her debt in 8 months.

Rewriting Script 3

Old belief: "'I must look successful online, no matter what it costs. What people see matters more than what's in my account.'" New belief: "My net worth matters more than my social media image. I build real wealth quietly."

First step: Audit your social media follows. Unfollow accounts that consistently make you feel financially inadequate or trigger impulse spending. Then check your last month of transactions for 'status purchases.'

Script 4 — Digital Money Vigilance (Excessive Distrust)

The Core Belief

'I do not trust digital money at all. Cash only. Digital platforms are all risky and unsafe.'

How It Shows Up Digitally

Avoiding online transactions even when safer and more convenient. Refusing licensed and insured mobile savings. Sticking exclusively to cash in an increasingly cashless economy. Missing digital investment returns and credit.

Where It Comes From

Often develops from personal experience of fraud, witnessing someone lose money, or hearing repeated cautionary tales. Healthy scepticism is a financial virtue — but excessive distrust that keeps you excluded from the digital economy is not.

The Cost of This Script

The cost is real: cash earns no interest, is harder to track, is vulnerable to physical theft, and excludes you from digital credit and investment products. In an increasingly cashless Africa, cash-only living carries its own

growing risks.

Rewriting Script 4

Old belief: "I do not trust digital money at all. Cash only. Digital platforms are all risky and unsafe." New belief: "I can use digital financial tools safely when I know what to look for and how to protect myself." First step: Make a list of your three biggest fears about digital money. Then research the factual safeguards (CBK consumer protection, account insurance, fraud reporting) that directly address each fear.

My Money Script Journal

Answer these questions honestly. Return to them in 30 days and notice what has shifted.

My dominant money script is:

Think back to your childhood. What messages did you receive about money from family or community?

How does this script show up in my digital financial life today?

The cost of this script to me has been:

The new belief I am committing to:

My first action to reinforce this new belief:

What would my financial life look like in 5 years if I rewrote this script?

Rewrite Your Script — 30-Day Challenge

1. Share your dominant script with one trusted person in your life. Ask if they see the same pattern.
2. For 7 days, keep a note on your phone of every financial decision influenced by your old script — no judgment, just observation.
3. Write your new belief somewhere you will see it daily: phone wallpaper, mirror, planner.
4. In 30 days, return to this page. How has your digital financial behaviour shifted?

Remember

Money scripts are not character flaws. They are survival strategies formed in childhood that have simply outlived their usefulness. Rewriting them is not about blame — it is about freedom.